three three two

(2025)

for chamber ensemble

adrian zhang

instrumentation:

clarinet in Bb

horn in F

bassoon

viola

violoncello

percussion (one player)
— marimba
— snare drum
— suspended cymbal (with bow)

program notes:

three three two is a play on the phrase itself; for example, the first and second movements are in ternary form, while the third and final movement is in binary form. throughout the piece, and especially in the first movement, san/san/er, the three-three-two ostinato is a significant motif. 3'32", the pointillistic second movement, aims to last that exact duration. lastly, TWO!!! ...and one is a celebratory final movement that uses the ideas of movements one and two, using the first half of the three-three-two rhythm and having the duration stated in the title.

performance notes:

the woodwinds' (and horn's) only uncommon technique is flutter-tongue, notated with flz. the percussionist will bow a suspended cymbal, and sometimes prepare to play in an uncommon manner: holding a mallet and bow at the same time.
oftentimes, instruments will be highlighted. soloistic passages are notated with "be heard!"

transposed score

three three two

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I: san/san/er

♩ = ca. 140. fun and playful.



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11
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.


♪ = ♪ sempre
A
16
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.


22
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.


27
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.


33
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.


37
B
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
pizz.


42
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
arco
vc.
to s. d.
mar.
4:5
mp
mf
p


48
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
snare drum
s. d.
4:5
mp
mf
p

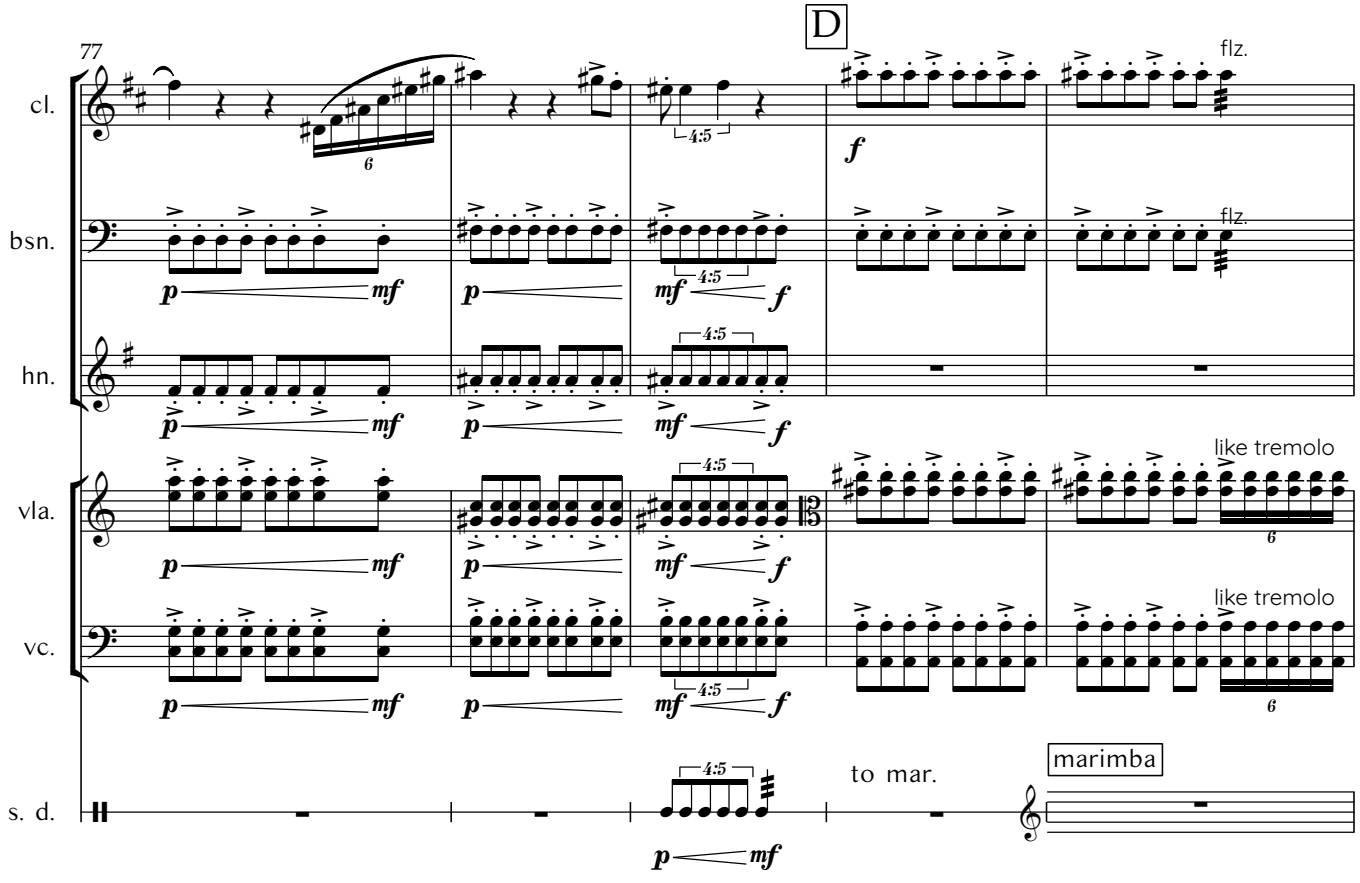

C
54
ord.
flz.
ord.
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
s. d.
be heard!
mf
p
f
4:5
6
3


59
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
s. d.
p
mf
4:5
6


63
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
s. d.
p
mf
4:5
6


68
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
s. d.
f
p
mf
4:5
6


73
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
s. d.


D
77
cl.
flz.
bsn.
flz.
hn.
vla.
like tremolo
vc.
like tremolo
s. d.
to mar.
marimba


82
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
ord.
flz.
ff
subito mp
be heard!
f


87
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
flz.
ord.


91
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
flz.
ord.
f


E
95
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
flz.
ord.
f
subito mf


99
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
flz.
ord.


103
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
flz.
ord.
be heard!
fp
mf
f
ff


107
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
flz.
ord.


F
112
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
pizz.


118
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
arco


123
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.


128
G
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
133
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.


137
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
f
p
f
p
f
p
f
3
p
f
f


140
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
p
f
p
f
p
f
p
f
p
f
p
f


144
H
♪ = ca. 128. stale. pointillistic.
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
marimba
151


157
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
162
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.


167
I
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
to sus. cym.
suspended cymbal
173
sus. cym.
press edge of cymbal with finger bow cymbal
to mar.

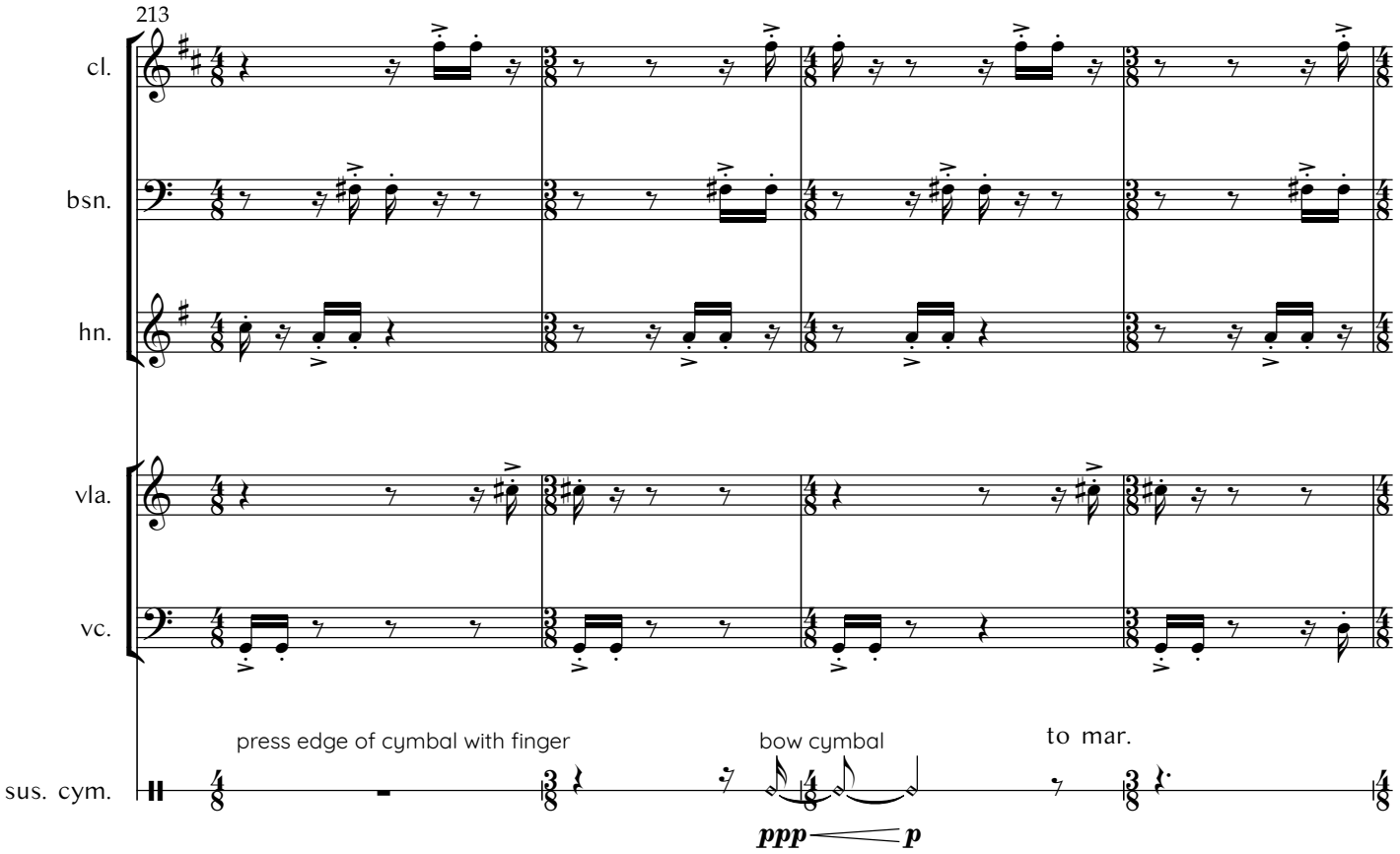

179
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
sus. cym.
marimba
dual-wield bow and mallet
press edge of cymbal with finger
to sus. cym.


185
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
sus. cym.
suspended cymbal
bow cymbal
normal playing
(use mallet)
press edge of cymbal with finger
bow cymbal
to mar.


191
J
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
sus. cym.
marimba
to sus. cym.
dual-wield
bow and mallet
press edge of cymbal
with finger
suspended cymbal
bow cymbal
197
normal playing
(use mallet)
to mar.


203
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
marimba
mar.
to sus. cym.
dual-wield
bow and mallet


209
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
suspended cymbal
normal playing
(use mallet)
press edge of cymbal with finger
bow cymbal
sus. cym.


213
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
sus. cym.
press edge of cymbal with finger
bow cymbal
to mar.
ppp
p


217
K
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
sus. cym.
p
f
marimba
3
f


224
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
ff


227
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
p
f


230
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
p
f


236
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
ff


241
L
♩ = ca. 80. celebratory, with building pride.
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
mar.
suspended cymbal
blend in!
246
sus. cym.


250
M
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
sus. cym.
f
p
mp
to s. d.
snare drum
blend in!
3
p
mf
255
s. d.


258
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
s. d.
3
3
mf
f
f


chromatic gliss!
260
cl.
bsn.
hn.
vla.
vc.
s. d.
ff
fff
ff
f
fff